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Scotch'n'Soda Theatre presents

THE ~~DEATH~~ OF DON JUAN

UC Studio Theatre

December 8th, 7pm & 11pm

December 9th, 3pm & 7pm

Directed by Rebecca Kira

Dramaturgy by Ursula Sturgeon

Written by Ursula Sturgeon



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A Note from the Creative Staff

While the tale of Don Juan spans back multiple centuries and lives throughout multiple iterations, *The Death of Don Juan*'s story begins in 2019, during Ursula Sturgeon's 3rd year of high school. The original draft was only a few pages and 15 minutes long, but it had a fun enough concept that it ended up sticking. Since then, she has worked tirelessly on the script to improve it and make it what it is today. Flash forward to September of 2023, she decides to produce her newly revised script at Carnegie Mellon. She sends out a call for interested directors, and this is how we meet Rebecca Kira: a first-year student at CMU who had always dreamed of directing, but never had the opportunity to do so. Needless to say, the two hit it off instantly and Rebecca was taken on as the director of *The Death of Don Juan*. Of course, it was not going to be a one-man show. Given this was going to be her first time directing, she would need some guidance; an assistant director and mentor director (Jocelyn Selby and Zach Everett-Lane) were brought on to the project, and the creative team was formed. The rest, as they say, is history.

The Death of Don Juan, while a fourth-wall breaking comedy, touches upon topics many of us can unfortunately relate to: lack of closure, grief, abusive relationships and our struggle to break free from them. Much like how the Playwright faces her less-than-perfect, manipulative, and condescending father, many of us have such a person in our own lives: a person we desperately want to look up to and admire, but who will never give us the validation, attention, and affection we need.

Interestingly, there is some suggestion that when Mozart wrote his opera Don Giovanni about the same characters, he was inspired by the death of his own father, whom he had a complex and closure-less relationship with. And according to a historical birth certificate, the writer of the very first Don Juan play, Tirso de Molina, may have had an absent nobleman father named Don Juan Tellez-Giron, who he would have never really gotten to know.

Time immemorial shows us that we may not always get closure. But at least, at the end of the day, we will still have each other.

Rebecca Kira
Director

Ursula Sturgeon
Dramaturg, Playwright

Content Warnings

This production includes depictions of physical and emotional abuse, prop firearms, death, and misogyny.

Creative Staff

Director: Rebecca Kira
Asst. Director: Jocelyn Selby
Mentor Director: Zachary Everett-Lane
Dramaturg: Ursula Sturgeon

Production Staff

Production Manager: Julia Levine
Asst. Production Manager: Harshitha Bharghava
Asst. Production Manager: Trey DuBose
Stage Manager: Flannery McNair
Asst. Stage Manager: Abigail Hartless
Technical Director: Andy Miller-Peterson
Technical Director: Quincy Mangi

Designers

Scenic Designer: Ella Sanfilippo
Lighting Designer: Claire Morrey
Sound Designer: Fiona Rubiano
Costume Designer: Chloe/Clover Brown
Hair & Makeup Designer: Ellie Clark
Publicity Head: Maddie Burroughs

Implementers

Lead Carpenter: Alex Echols
Co-Paint Charge: Adriana Holtzman
Co-Paint Charge: Jacqueline Germer
Lead Electrician: Claire Morrey
Asst. Lead Electrician: Maddie Burroughs
Sound Engineer: Fiona Rubiano
Costumes Head: Chloe/Clover Brown
Co-Hair & Makeup Head: Kyr Brenneman
Co-Hair & Makeup Head: Abby Glass
Co-Props Manager: Lillian McDermott
Co-Props Manager: Madison England

Paint Crew

Chase Crandall
Ellie Burckhardt
J.E. Feliciano

Lighting Crew

Adriana Holtzman
Ella Sanfilippo
Kira Lentz

Cast

Don Juan Tenorio: J. E. Feliciano
Leoporello: Chase Crandall
Donna Elvira: Marissa Fernandez
Donna Anna: Arrin Jung
Masetto: Nate Perez
Donna Ximena / Stagehand: Emily Guo
The Playwright: Ella Mineroff
The Playwright's Father: Tanyi He

Sound Crew

Lucy Feng

Hair & Makeup Crew

Levi Chaplin-Loebell
Jacqueline Germer

Carpentry Crew

Chloe/Clover Brown
Flannery McNair

Props Crew

Jacey Lozada
Soomin Kong